

# The AI Tool Landscape — Beyond ChatGPT

CSPS AI Training Workshop · 24–28 August 2026 · a companion sheet, not a ranking

**How to read this sheet.** All of these tools are capable general assistants — the differences that matter day-to-day are *where they live* (inside your documents? grounded in your sources?) and *what they are best at*. The skills you learn this week (clear instructions, data discipline, verification) transfer to every one of them. Capabilities change fast; treat this as a map drawn in August 2026, not a permanent atlas.

| Tool                                                   | What it is                                                                                                                                                              | Everyday work                                                                 | Research use                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>ChatGPT</b><br>OpenAI                               | The most widely used general assistant; strong all-rounder with data-analysis and image features.                                                                       | Drafting, brainstorming, summaries, spreadsheet help.                         | Exploratory analysis, coding help; verify sources it cites.               |
| <b>Claude</b><br>Anthropic                             | Assistant known for careful long-form writing and working through long documents.                                                                                       | Reports and memos; reading long PDFs; polished tone.                          | Literature synthesis, structured analysis, code for data work.            |
| <b>Gemini</b><br>Google                                | Google's assistant, integrated with Gmail, Docs and Drive; strong multimodal features.                                                                                  | Working inside Google Workspace; translation; images and video understanding. | Deep-research style sourced reports; verify before citing.                |
| <b>Copilot</b><br>Microsoft                            | Assistant built into Windows, Edge and (with licences) Word, Excel and Outlook.                                                                                         | Drafting inside Office files; email triage; meeting recaps.                   | Less research-focused; useful where your data already lives in Office.    |
| <b>Gemini Notebook</b><br>Google · formerly NotebookLM | A source-grounded notebook: it answers ONLY from documents you upload, with citations — and can turn them into an audio overview. Renamed from NotebookLM in July 2026. | Briefings grounded in your own reports; onboarding packs.                     | The safest of these for document-bound Q&A; still read the cited passage. |
| <b>Perplexity</b><br>Perplexity AI                     | A search-first assistant: answers come with linked web sources by default.                                                                                              | Quick oriented lookups with references to check.                              | First-pass scans of a topic; every citation must be opened and read.      |

## The rules that do not change, whichever tool you use

- **Three-way data sort:** Public — paste freely · Internal — anonymise first · Confidential — never into a public tool.
- **Verify before you rely:** find one thing to fix in every output; source-shaped text is not a source.
- **Instruct in five parts:** Role · Task · Context · Constraints · Format — works identically in all six tools.
- **Pick by task, not by loyalty:** long document → Claude/Gemini Notebook · inside Office → Copilot · inside Google → Gemini · sourced scan → Perplexity.